

Galago moholi

Moholi bushbaby



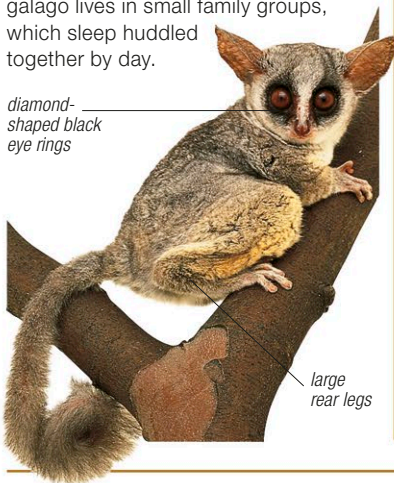
Length 4¼–6½ in (12–17 cm)
Tail 6½–11 in (16–28 cm)
Weight 5½–8 oz (160–225 g)
Social unit Variable
Status Least concern

Location E., C., and southern Africa



The moholi bushbaby is also called the lesser bushbaby. It leaps vertically, in enormous jumps of 16 ft (5 m), and its grasping hands and feet are moistened regularly with urine, to maintain grip. It snatches insects from midair by hand or scrapes gum from trees with its comblike lower front teeth. This galago lives in small family groups, which sleep huddled together by day.

diamond-shaped black eye rings



large rear legs

Cheirogaleus medius

Fat-tailed dwarf lemur



Length 7–10 in (17–26 cm)
Tail 7½–12 in (19–30 cm)
Weight 4 oz (135 g)

Location W. and S. Madagascar

Social unit Individual/Group
Status Least concern



gray, red, or buff fur on upper parts

The fat-tailed dwarf lemur stores food as fat in its body and tail, to survive the 8-month dry season, during which it remains torpid, huddled with others of its kind. When active again, it becomes solitary and clammers in trees and bushes at night, seeking flowers, fruit, and insects. It rests by day in a leaf-and-twigs nest in a tree-hole or fork.

Varecia variegata

Black and white ruffed lemur



Length 18 in (45 cm)
Tail 23½–24 in (60–61 cm)
Weight 6½–15 lb (3–7 kg)

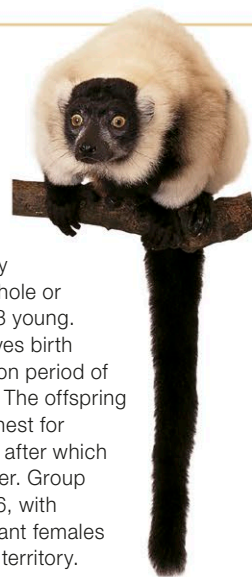
Location E. Madagascar

Social unit Group
Status Critically endangered



This large species is white or reddish white except for black on the face, shoulders, chest, flanks, feet, and tail.

The black and white ruffed lemur eats a higher proportion of fruit than any other lemur. It builds a leafy nest in a tree-hole or fork for its 2–3 young. The female gives birth after a gestation period of 96–106 days. The offspring remain in the nest for several weeks after which they cling to her. Group size is up to 16, with several dominant females defending the territory.



Eulemur macaco

Black lemur



Length 15½ in (39 cm)
Tail 20–26 in (51–65 cm)
Weight 2¼–4½ lb (1–2 kg)

Location N. Madagascar

Social unit Group
Status Vulnerable



A medium-sized species, only the male has the long, soft black fur for which it is named. Females are red, brown, or gray. Unlike most lemurs, the



ruff of long fur around neck and ears

black lemur is also active for part of the night. This behavior may result from hunting and other human disturbance. Led by one female, groups of 5–15 black lemurs forage mainly in trees for fruit, flowers, leaves, and soft bark.

Haplemur griseus

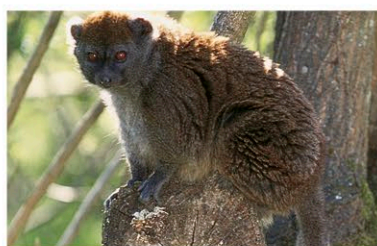
Gray gentle lemur



Length 11–12 in (28–30 cm)
Tail 14–14½ in (35–37 cm)
Weight 28½–34 lb (813–967 kg)

Location Madagascar

Social unit Group
Status Vulnerable



This species is restricted to humid forests and marshy areas where reeds and the bamboo, on which it feeds, are abundant. It usually lives in groups of 2–7 and is active mainly at dawn and dusk. Females have a single offspring, which is carried underneath the body at first and later on the back. Disturbance of its restricted habitat threatens this specialized lemur.

Lemur catta

Ring-tailed lemur



Length 15½–18 in (39–46 cm)
Tail 22–24 in (56–62 cm)
Weight 4½ lb (2.2 kg)

Location S. and S.W. Madagascar

Social unit Group
Status Endangered



This lemur spends more time than its relatives on the ground, even though it is a skilled climber. Very sociable, it forms groups of 5–25, with a core of adult females showing a well-defined hierarchy among themselves and over any males. Young females remain with their mothers and sisters; juvenile males

move to other groups. Using their hands, they gather flowers, fruit, leaves, bark, and sap. After 138–141 days' gestation, the female bears one (sometimes 2) offspring. It first clings to the mother's underside and then rides on her back. Like most lemurs, this lemur faces many threats, especially habitat loss.

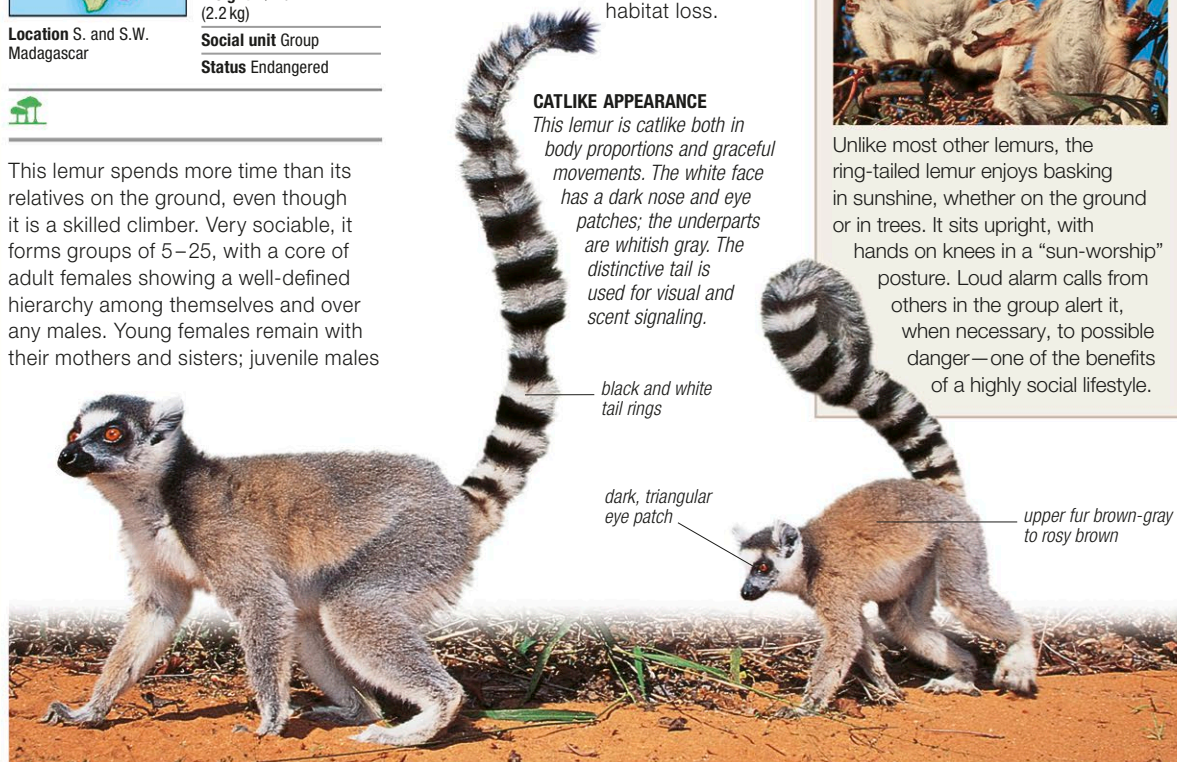
CATLIKE APPEARANCE

This lemur is catlike both in body proportions and graceful movements. The white face has a dark nose and eye patches; the underparts are whitish gray. The distinctive tail is used for visual and scent signaling.

black and white tail rings

dark, triangular eye patch

upper fur brown-gray to rosy brown



SUNBATHING



Unlike most other lemurs, the ring-tailed lemur enjoys basking in sunshine, whether on the ground or in trees. It sits upright, with hands on knees in a "sun-worship" posture. Loud alarm calls from others in the group alert it, when necessary, to possible danger—one of the benefits of a highly social lifestyle.